

S04-01 - Through the Farms

Player read-aloud

Blue moss glows over the crops like starlight caught in soil. The trees ahead have faces carved into every side.

Scene summary

The road to the Custodian passes through mosslit farms and carved watching trees.

Visible choices

- Ask about tree faces
- Follow locals? directions
- Watch for ward magic

Player questions

- What detail in Through the Farms tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

Raw source

- Id: S04-01
- Act: Act Four
- Title: Through the Farms
- Beats: Threshold / transition Emotional beat
- Image: assets/scenes/S04-01-through-the-farms.png
- Short: The road to the Custodian passes through mosslit farms and carved watching trees.
- Long: The scene drifts from cozy village into older magic. The land is alive and watching.
- Read: Blue moss glows over the crops like starlight caught in soil. The trees ahead have faces carved into every side.
- Gm: This is a good place to ask Khari's old name for Sablewood if it has not come up.
- Entities: Hush Farms Old Sable Whitefire Custodian The Hanging Office Open Vale? Ritual Site Goldspire Territories Sablewood? Logistics Preserve Lausa Standworth Route Assurance Contract Marlowe Fairwind Khari Nix
- Choices: Ask about tree faces Follow locals? directions Watch for ward magic
- Prompt: Adventurers walk through mosslit farmland at twilight, glowing blue moss over crops, carved tree faces, Hush behind them; no strixwolf, no undead.
- Source Entities: Hush Farms Old Sable Whitefire Custodian
- Beat Codes: threshold-transition emotional-beat
- Slug: S04-01-through-the-farms
- Act Title: The Hanging Office

- Arc Role: Mentor-custodian truth reveal
- Caption: The road through the farms shifts the story from delivery job to stewardship problem.
- Image Alt: Through the Farms scene art for The Hanging Office.
- Image Prompt Used: Adventurers walk through mosslit farmland at twilight, glowing blue moss over crops, carved tree faces, Hush behind them; no strixwolf, no undead. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions unless explicitly requested. No strixwolf, no Bramble Union, no undead. Focus on the Custodian and the Keystone Asset reveal. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: The scene drifts from cozy village into older magic. The land is alive and watching. Run this scene as mentor-custodian truth reveal: The road through the farms shifts the story from delivery job to stewardship problem. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: Blue moss glows over the crops like starlight caught in soil. The trees ahead have faces carved into every side.
- Gm Notes: This is a good place to ask Khari's old name for Sablewood if it has not come up. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- Sensory Details: irrigation water ticking in channels ward posts buzzing under peeling paint soil after rain
- Body Language: Local guides keep touching ward stones without noticing Marlowe's confidence thins
- Sample Dialogue: Lausa Standworth The office hangs where old branches can hold what companies forget.
- Checks: Instinct Notice ward posts failing unevenly. Easy Foreshadow ritual instability. 10 Clearly resolve: Notice ward posts failing unevenly. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Through the Farms. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.
- Choices Consequences: Ask locals about failures Learn recent incidents. Custodian conversation starts informed. Stay contract-focused Arrive faster. Truth lands harder.
- Clues: Uneven ward buzz The ward is failing. Open Vale is the convergence point. The protective network is deteriorating in patches.
- Loot: Soil sample Ward-post rubbing
- Payoff Flags: Custodian Trust Track
- Filters: act-four choice custodian-trust-track emotional-beat gm-only the-hanging-office threshold--transition location npc manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned clue
- Index: 13
- Player Questions: What detail in Through the Farms tells you the official story is

incomplete? Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it? What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?

- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in Through the Farms that belongs to your character's point of view.

- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer.

Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress.

Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-

focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne:

notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits.

Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices

stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one

sensory or social detail from the player's heritage.

Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.

- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to expose neglected infrastructure, stress the Custodian, or make the Keystone hum at the wrong moment. Make neglected infrastructure answer at the wrong moment. Stress the Custodian's trust without turning her into a device.

- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. The sealed package is the capital's ward Keystone; the city is unwarded while it is away. KEEP GUARANTEED "The wood never needed managing. It needed leaving alone." ADD SEED "Your capital's safety is older than your contracts. It is the very thing they teach you to fear."

ADD SEED The Keystone's magic is pre-corporate forest-ward work, the same school companies call primitive. ADD EARNED Knowledge Hard 20 The Custodian glances at obsolete Soulspire inspection seals on her counterweight boulder. ADD EARNED Instinct Medium 15 Presence: earn candor. Knowledge: place the magic. Instinct: read the Custodian's fear. ACT4 Act 4: Hanging Office 160 2:05 to 2:40 2:40 Custodian, Keystone reveal, new objective, short rest Compress the reveal; bank the Short Rest into travel narration.

- Mechanics: The party is in Act Four pressure: The road to the Custodian passes through mosslit farms and carved watching trees. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s04-01-navigate-the-farms-at-dusk S04-01 Navigate the farms at dusk Navigate the farms at dusk Instinct Agility Instinct Agility 11 Instinct reads paths; Agility keeps footing. The party loses time before the Custodian. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the

GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The party loses time before the Custodian. Use a hard complication...

- Roll Cards: s04-01-navigate-the-farms-at-dusk S04-01 Navigate the farms at dusk
Navigate the farms at dusk Instinct Agility Instinct Agility 11 Instinct reads paths; Agility keeps footing. The party loses time before the Custodian. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The party loses time before the Custodian. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core result, but it costs time, noise, leverage, or a visible resource...
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Through the Farms asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Agility, Finesse, Instinct, Knowledge. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Location Ids: hush-farms the-hanging-office open-valetm-ritual-site goldspire-territories sablewoodtm-logistics-preserve old-sable
- Clueids: route-assurance-contractm the-ward-subscription the-drained-water the-patched-everything
- Clue Ids: route-assurance-contractm the-ward-subscription the-drained-water the-patched-everything
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